

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 10 · Contemporary America (1964–2016) · US.83–US.95

Match the task to the tool — then
teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of "why it happened" visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put events in order / show change over time	● Timeline	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes cause across time. <i>Builds SSP.05 chronology.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO (or OPTIC)	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem-Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national history stick — and it's what sets History Hack apart. Our signature move.

SSP Crosswalk

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

Which organizer builds which practice — and where it lives in Unit 10

Every organizer in this toolkit is also a **skills tool**. Use this crosswalk to name the Tennessee Social Studies Practice you're building — and to pick the organizer that builds it best.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO	BUILD IT WITH	USE IT WHEN · WHERE IN UNIT 10
SSP.01 Collect Information	Gather facts from primary & secondary sources.	5 Ws Main Idea & Details K-W-L	Intake: pulling the who/what/when and key ideas out of a reading, image, or lecture.
SSP.02 Critically Examine Sources	Interrogate a source: author, audience, point of view, purpose, reliability.	HIPPO C-E-R	Any primary source in US.83–US.95 — a Watergate hearing clip, a Reagan speech, or an Apollo-era news broadcast.
SSP.03 Synthesize Data	Organize & combine data from several sources into one picture.	Comparison matrix Concept web Main Idea	US.91 (Clinton's policies) & US.93 (women & minorities in leadership) — holding many cases against one yardstick.
SSP.04 Construct & Communicate with Evidence	Build and defend an argument or explanation with evidence.	C-E-R T-chart Problem–Solution	US.94 (1970s vs. present-day communication) — compare two.
SSP.05 Develop Historical Awareness	Sequence in time, trace cause & effect, and see change over time.	Timeline Cause & Effect Concept web	US.86 (Watergate's unfolding) & US.90 (Bush's foreign-policy events in order).
SSP.06 Develop Geographic Awareness	Read place, region & spatial patterns; connect geography to events.	Modern map ★ Tennessee Connection	US.92 (Fort Campbell to Afghanistan) — and every Tennessee Connection (Tellico Dam, Chattanooga's 'Gig City').

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Compare 2 Things

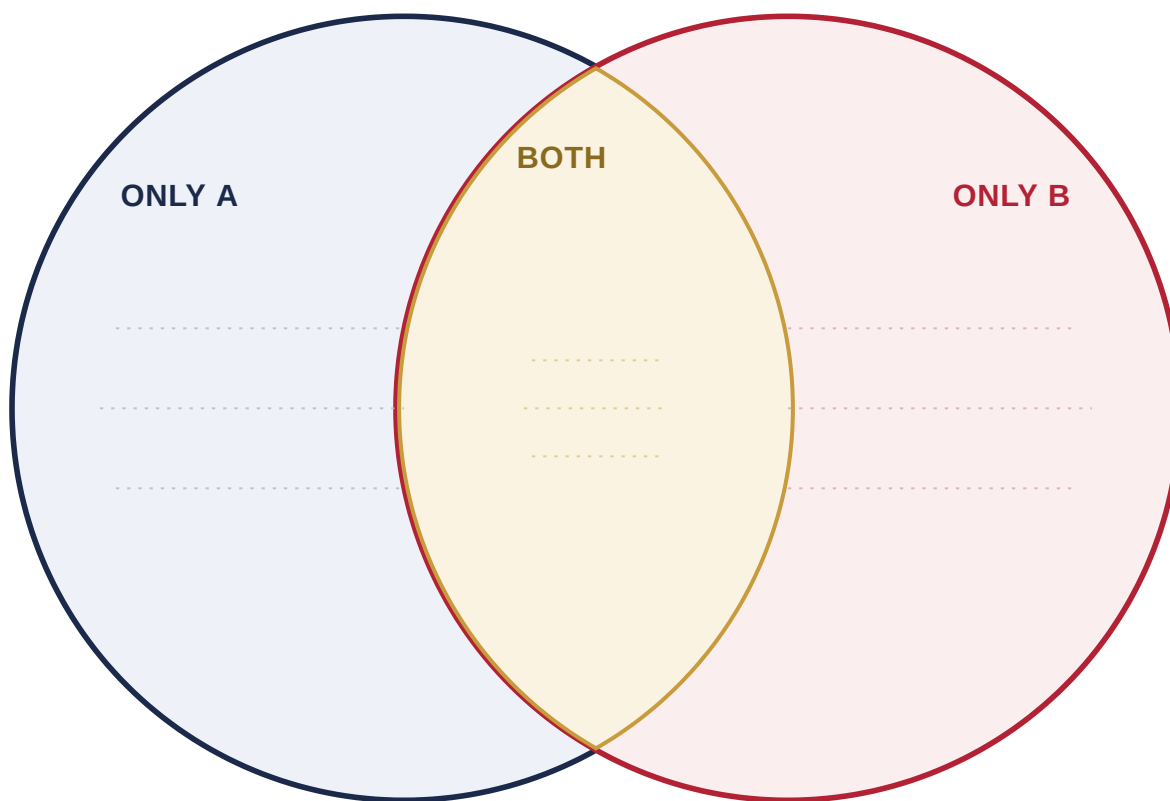
DOK 2 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare two** things — the overlap makes shared traits visible and forces precise differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

In each circle, write what is unique to that topic. In the middle, write what they share.

Topic A: _____

Topic B: _____



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and a sentence starter: "Both ____ and ____ are ____." Let pairs fill the BOTH region first.

EXTEND

Rank the differences: which one matters most, and why? Defend it in one sentence of evidence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

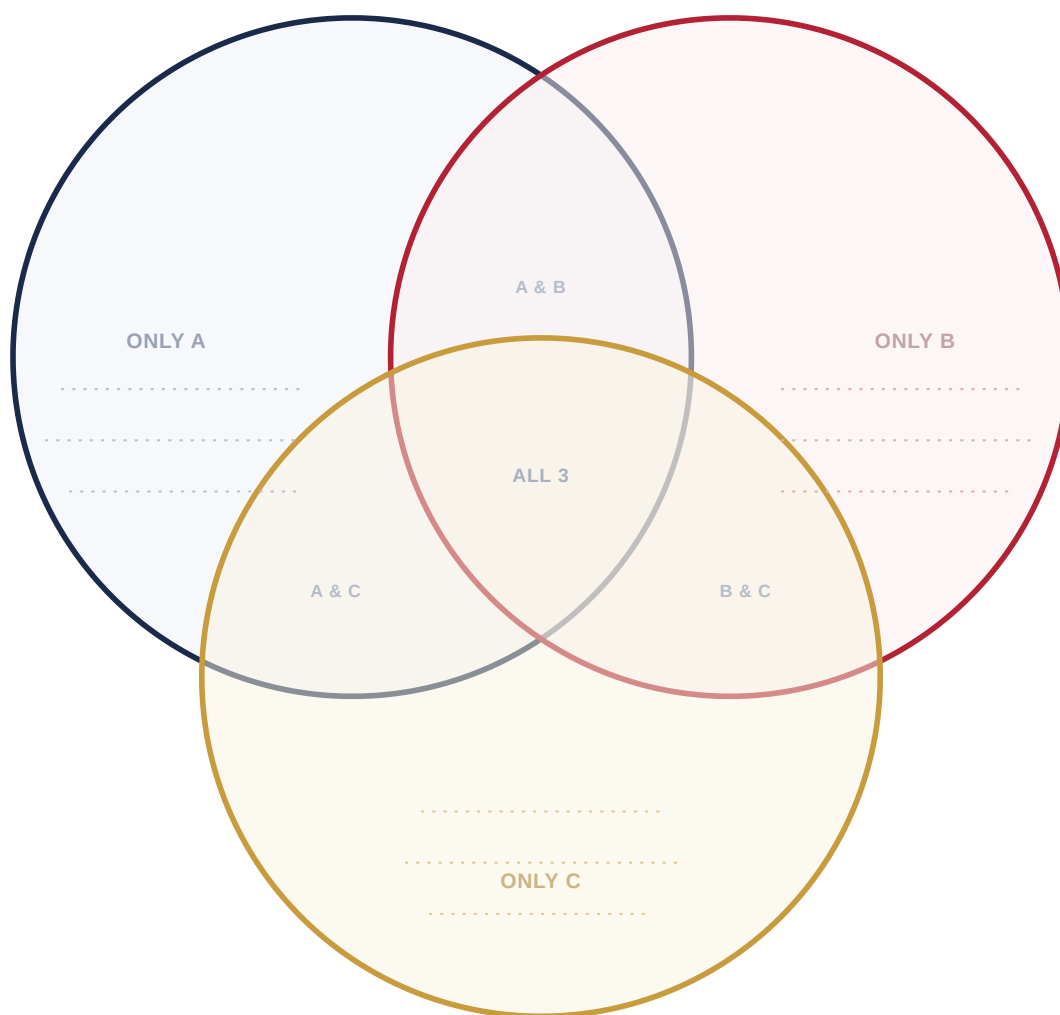
Compare 3

DOK 2-3 • Comparison

WHEN • WHY Use when a task asks students to **compare three** things at once — the overlaps expose what is shared by two, what is shared by all three, and what stays unique. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each topic in the key, then fill the circles: unique traits in the single lobes, shared traits where they overlap.

○ Topic A: _____ ○ Topic B: _____ ○ Topic C: _____



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank and start with the ALL 3 center: "All three share ____." Let pairs fill one lobe at a time.

EXTEND

Argue which topic is the "odd one out" and defend it with one trait from its unique lobe.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the circles with sticky notes.

🕒 10-15 min

Compare 2

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **two** things head-to-head on points you choose, lining up each trait side-by-side so real differences stand out. *Identifying similarities & differences is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

[illegible]

Synthesis — the most important difference, and why it matters

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons, or **build** the two columns with sticky notes.

WHEN · WHY Use to compare **three or more** things across several named criteria at once, so patterns across the whole set become visible. *Comparing on structured criteria — identifying similarities & differences — is the highest-yield strategy for learning gains (Marzano).*

Name each option across the top and each criterion down the side. Fill every box with what that option shows for that criterion. Then name the pattern you see.

CRITERIA ↓ OPTIONS →	Option A	Option B	Option C
CRITERION 1			
CRITERION 2			
CRITERION 3			

Pattern · conclusion — what the whole matrix tells you

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Pre-name one or two criteria and a starter:
“On ___, Option A ___ while Option C ___.” Complete one row as a class.

EXTEND
In the conclusion, explain *why* the pattern holds — what causes options to line up or split the way they do?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** symbols in cells, or **build** the grid with cards.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Causes / Effects

SSP.05 · DOK 2–3

WHEN · WHY Use when a task asks **what led to** an event and **what followed** from it — separating causes from effects builds reasoning about change over time. *Analyzing cause & effect is a core TN Social Studies Practice (SSP.05).*

List what led to the event on the left, then what followed from it on the right. Arrows show the flow: causes → event → effects.

CAUSES · WHAT LED TO IT	THE EVENT	EFFECTS · WHAT FOLLOWED
Cause 1	EVENT / TOPIC NAME THE EVENT OR DECISION	Effect 1
Cause 2		Effect 2
Cause 3		Effect 3

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Offer sentence frames: “Because ____, the event happened,” and “As a result, ____.” Fill the event box first.

EXTEND

Rank the causes from most to least important, or trace one effect into a new cause (a chain).

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** arrows/icons, or **build** it with cards.

Timeline — Order & Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Order / sequence

SSP.05 • Chronology

WHEN • WHY Use to put events in **order** and see how things **change over time** — the vertical spine makes sequence and distance between events visible. *Chronological reasoning — ordering events and tracking change — is a core practice (TN Social Studies Practices SSP.05).*

Order the events from earliest (top) to latest (bottom). On each line, write the date on the left, then what happened on the right.

▲ EARLIEST

ORDER • CHANGE OVER TIME

DATE / WHEN

1

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

2

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

3

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

4

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS

DATE / WHEN

5

WHAT HAPPENED • WHY IT MATTERS



LATEST / MOST RECENT

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards and have students **physically sequence** them before writing. Sentence starter: "First ____, then ____, and finally ____."

EXTEND

Mark the moment of biggest **change**. Explain in one sentence what caused it and what it changed.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** dates, **say** the sequence aloud, **draw** an icon per event, or **build** the line with cards.

Concept Web

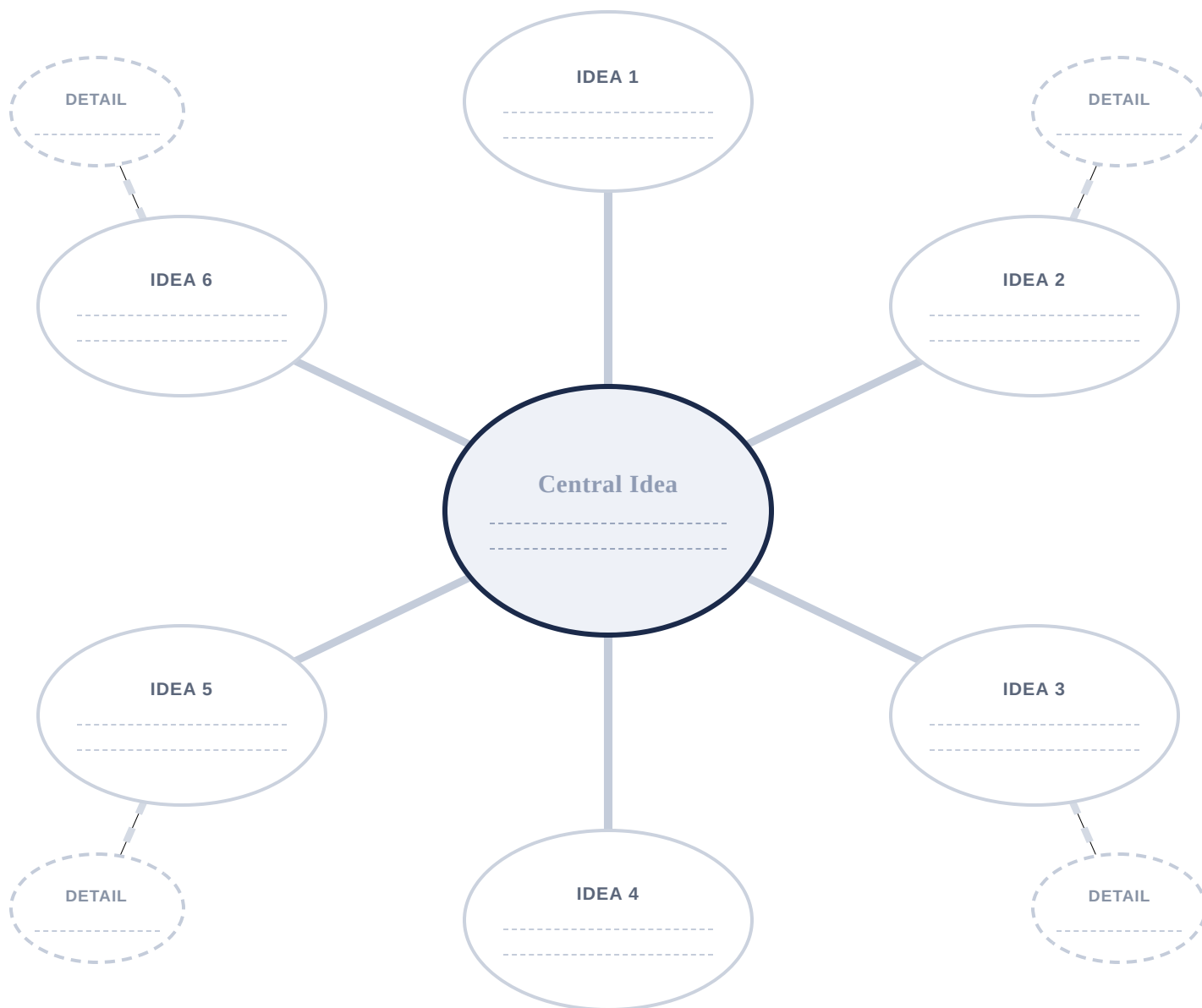
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Brainstorm / connect

DOK 2 • Relationships

WHEN • WHY Use to **brainstorm** around a central concept and show how ideas branch and **connect** to it. The hub-and-spoke shape makes relationships between ideas visible at a glance. *Organizing ideas into a nonlinear web supports schema-building (UDL 3.0).*

Write the big idea in the center. On each outer bubble, add an idea that connects to it — then use the small bubbles for a supporting detail.



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SCAFFOLD

Seed two bubbles for students and give a linking stem: "This connects to the center because ____."

EXTEND

Draw new lines **between** outer bubbles that relate to each other and label what the link is.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** icons in bubbles, or **build** it with sticky notes.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Summarize

DOK 2 • Main Idea

WHEN • WHY Use to pull the **central point** out of a text or lecture and anchor it to the details and evidence that support it.
Summarizing — keeping the main idea and cutting the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).

Write the main idea at the top. In each box below, add a detail or piece of evidence that supports it — the arrows show every detail holding the main idea up. Then say it all in one sentence.

MAIN IDEA

↑ THESE DETAILS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Detail 4

Summary — the whole thing in one sentence

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SCAFFOLD

Give a main-idea frame: "This is mostly about ____ because ____." Fill one detail box together before students work.

EXTEND

Rank the details from strongest to weakest support, or add a detail that would *weaken* the main idea.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon per detail, or **build** it with labeled cards.

🕒 10-15 min

Activate + track

DOK 1–2 · Metacognition

TOPIC _____

[illegible]

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Fill **K** as a whole class on chart paper first.
Give question stems for **W**: "I wonder ____"
/ "How does ____?"

In **L**, mark which of your **W** questions got answered — and write one new question you still have.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** what they know and learned in each column.

5 Ws — Who • What • When • Where • Why

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Use to quickly capture the **essential facts** of an event — who, what, when, where, and why (plus how). The hub-and-spoke keeps every key question in view at once. *Establishing the who/what/when/where anchors chronological reasoning (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Name the event in the center, then answer each spoke to capture the essential facts. (Use How to stretch to six.)

WHO • PEOPLE

WHAT • HAPPENED

WHEN • TIME

WHERE • PLACE

WHY • REASON

HOW • THE WAY

EVENT / TOPIC • NAME IT HERE

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide sentence stems for each spoke:
 “This happened because ____,” “It took place in ____.”

EXTEND

Turn the six facts into a one-sentence summary, or rank which W matters most for understanding the event.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** the spokes with cards.

WHEN · WHY Use to define a **problem**, weigh two or three possible solutions against their likely results, and justify the best choice with evidence. *Generating & testing possible solutions is a high-yield reasoning strategy (Marzano); it builds cause-effect thinking (TN SSP.05).*

State the problem, map 2–3 possible solutions with their likely results, then choose the best one and justify it. Follow the arrows: problem → options → decision.

PROBLEM — what is wrong, and for whom?

WEIGH THE OPTIONS

Possible Solution 1	Possible Solution 2	Possible Solution 3
Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off	Likely result · trade-off

DECIDE

Best solution + justification — I chose ____ because...

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Provide the problem and one solution; students supply the rest. Offer a starter: "If we ____, then ____ because ____."

EXTEND
Add a second criterion (cost *and* fairness) and explain a trade-off you are willing to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** the flow, or **build** the options with cards and vote.

🕒 10-15 min

Learn a term

WHEN · WHY Use to build **deep word knowledge** — not just a definition, but traits, examples, and non-examples that sharpen the boundary of a concept. *Contrasting examples with non-examples strengthens concept learning (Marzano — similarities & differences).*

1. DEFINITION — IN YOUR OWN WORDS

2. CHARACTERISTICS / FACTS

TERM / WORD

3. EXAMPLES

4. NON-EXAMPLES

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

Pre-fill the term and one example. Offer a definition frame: "A ____ is a ____ that ____." Let partners brainstorm non-examples aloud first.

Add a sentence using the term correctly, then explain **why** one non-example does *not* fit.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw** an icon for each example, or **build** the quadrants with sticky notes.

Claim • Evidence • Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Make a claim

DOK 3 • Argument

WHEN • WHY Use to build an **evidence-based argument** — a defensible claim, the evidence that supports it, and the reasoning that ties them together. *Constructing arguments from evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

State your claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning — how the evidence proves the claim.

CLAIM — my answer to the question

BACKED BY



EVIDENCE — facts, quotes & details that prove it

1

2

3

WHICH PROVES



REASONING — this evidence supports my claim because...

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a claim frame: “___ because ___.” and a reasoning starter: “This shows ___ because ___.” Fill just one evidence box first.

EXTEND

Add a **counterclaim** and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record) the argument, or **build** it from evidence cards before writing.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Analyze a source

DOK 3 • Sourcing

WHEN • WHY Use to **interrogate a primary source** so students read like historians — questioning context, audience, point of view, and purpose instead of taking it at face value. *Sourcing and contextualizing evidence is a core disciplinary practice (TN Social Studies Practices).*

Cite the source, then interrogate it — read it like a historian, one H-I-P-P-O question at a time.

SOURCE — title / author / date

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT *What was happening at the time?*

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE *Who was it made for?*

P

POINT OF VIEW *Who made it — what is their bias / perspective?*

P

PURPOSE *Why was it made? What did they want?*

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION *What do you already know that connects?*

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SCAFFOLD

Model one letter aloud with the class first. Provide a question stem per box and let partners discuss before writing.

EXTEND

Rank the five letters: which one most changes how you should **trust** this source, and why?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write, say** (record) their analysis, or **annotate** the source directly.

Tennessee Connection

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Local ↔ National

DOK 3 • Connect

WHEN • WHY History sticks when it comes home. This organizer links a national event to a Tennessee person, place, or law — then asks students to argue why the local story matters. *Relevance and personal connection drive engagement and retention (UDL 3.0).*

Zoom in: link the national story to Tennessee — then say why the local story matters.

National topic / standard: _____

THE NATIONAL STORY

WHAT HAPPENED ACROSS THE U.S.?

THE TENNESSEE STORY

A TN PERSON, PLACE, OR LAW



THE LINK — how does the Tennessee story connect to the national one?

WHY THE LOCAL STORY MATTERS — why should Tennesseans know this?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide the TN name/place and one national fact; students write only the *link* sentence: "This connects because ____."

EXTEND

Argue whether the Tennessee example is typical of the nation or an exception — and what that tells us.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** the link aloud, **draw** a map line from TN to the nation, or **build** it as a matching pair.

The Great Society: A War on Poverty

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

⌚ 15-20 min

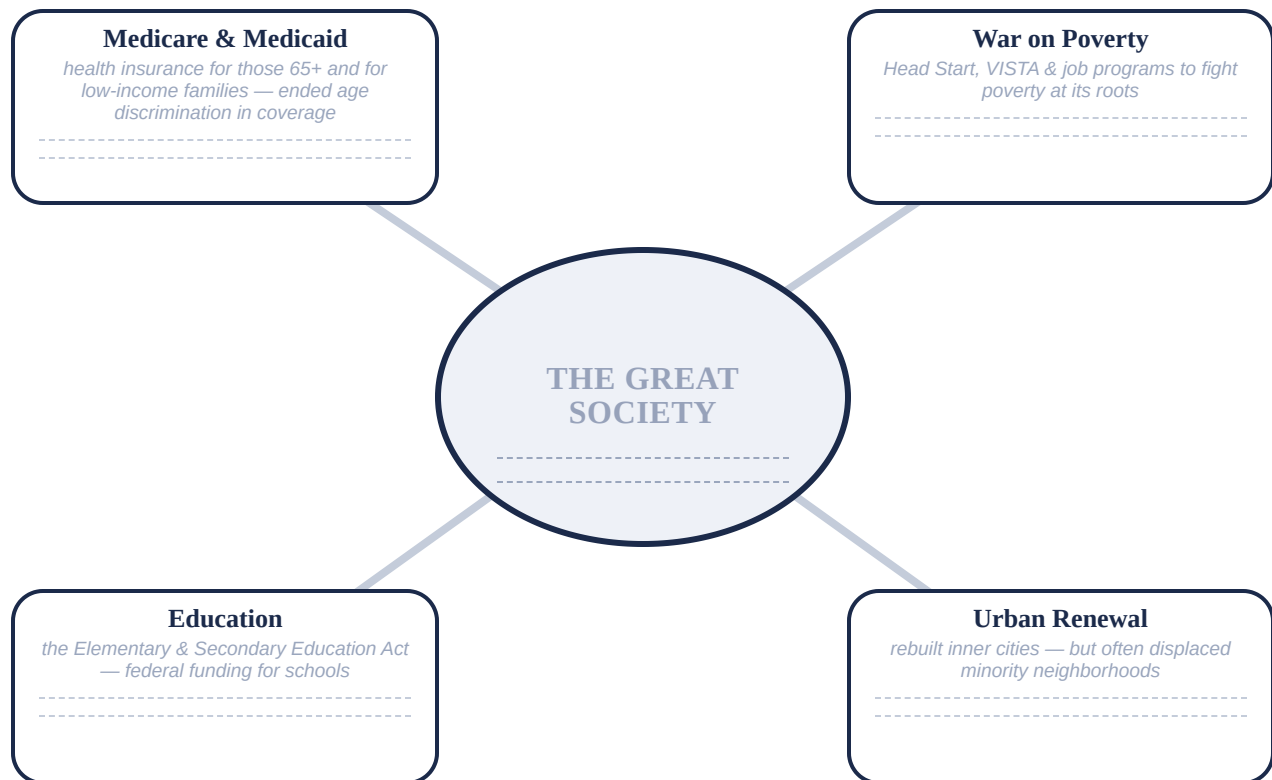
Concept Web

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2–3 • Analyze

WHEN • WHY A web shows the Great Society's many programs as one ambitious agenda — and lets students weigh which delivered and which caused harm. *Connecting parts to one hub builds SSP.03 (synthesize).*

The hub is Johnson's domestic vision. On each bubble, write what that program did — the faint notes are starters. Then answer the box below: what did the Great Society promise, and where did it fall short?



What did the Great Society promise — and where did it fall short?

a promise to end poverty & expand healthcare · Medicare endured, but urban renewal displaced communities and costs rose faster than projected

★ **Tennessee Connection.** The Great Society reached deep into Tennessee: the **Appalachian Regional Commission** invested in East Tennessee's roads and schools, **Medicare** transformed care for the state's elderly, and **Head Start** spread across rural communities.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the four bubble labels; fill Medicare together. Ask: who did this program help?

EXTEND

Which program did the most good, and which did the most harm? Use the urban-renewal bubble to argue.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** an icon for each program.

The Generation Gap

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

T-Chart • Two Sides

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2–3 • Compare

WHEN • WHY A two-column chart sets the generations side by side, so students see the “gap” as two worldviews shaped by two very different histories — not just old vs. young. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's #1 strategy.*

Each side of the 1960s “generation gap” had its own view of activism and authority. On each card, write what that side believed — the faint notes are starters. Then answer the band below.

THE ESTABLISHMENT

the older generation

Shaped by hard times

grew up through the Depression & World War II — valued sacrifice & duty

Trust in authority

respected institutions, tradition & the government they had built and defended

Critics of protest

saw many protesters as unpatriotic radicals hurting the country & the troops

THE COUNTERCULTURE

the younger generation

Raised in prosperity

grew up in postwar comfort — freer to question the world their parents made

Question authority

challenged traditional values, the Vietnam War & “the establishment”

Hippies & Woodstock

rejected materialism; embraced peace, music & community (Woodstock, 1969)

Why did the two generations clash so sharply in the 1960s?

Different life experiences (Depression & war vs. postwar plenty) led to opposite views of patriotism, authority, and how much America needed to change

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee felt these currents its own way: **Nashville's** music scene absorbed countercultural influences, **Vanderbilt University** became a center of student activism, and the **Highlander** center kept training social-justice organizers.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill one card on each side together, using the faint notes. Ask: what did each side fear losing?

EXTEND

Was the counterculture a healthy challenge or a threat to American values? Argue with evidence from both columns.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** the cards, **say** a side's view aloud, or **design** a 1960s protest or pro-tradition poster.

Nixon: Achievements in a Shadowed Presidency

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN · WHY A main-idea organizer separates the **big idea** from the details, so students can hold Nixon’s real achievements and his fall in view at the same time. *Summarizing — keep the main idea, cut the rest — is a high-yield comprehension strategy (Marzano).*

Fill each detail box first, using the faint hints as anchors. Then infer the main idea all four support and write it up top — the arrows show every detail holding it up. Finish with one summary sentence.

MAIN IDEA

Though Watergate ended his presidency, Nixon achieved a great deal at home and abroad.

↑ THESE FOUR ACHIEVEMENTS SUPPORT THE MAIN IDEA ↑

Foreign-Policy Breakthroughs	Domestic Reforms	The “Silent Majority”	Vietnamization
Opened relations with China (1972); <i>détente</i> & the SALT I arms treaty with the USSR.	Created the EPA; Title IX for gender equality; the 26th Amendment — voting age 18.	Appealed to Americans who didn’t protest — reshaping the Republican coalition for decades.	Gradually withdrew U.S. troops while backing South Vietnam — which ultimately fell.

In one sentence, how should we remember the Nixon presidency?

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Tennessee Senator **Howard Baker** served as Senate Minority Leader during these years — a leading Republican voice who would soon become a national figure in the Watergate hearings.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the four detail boxes first using the faint hints, then infer the main idea together.
Frame: “All four show that ____.”

EXTEND
Historians debate Nixon’s legacy. Use the boxes to argue: do his achievements or Watergate define him?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** the boxes, **say** the main idea aloud, or **rank** the four achievements.

Watergate: How a Break-In Toppled a President

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline • Change Over Time

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2 • Chronology

WHEN • WHY A timeline shows the chain from burglary to cover-up to court ruling to resignation — and why the cover-up, not the crime, brought Nixon down. *Chronological reasoning is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Follow the scandal from top (earliest) to bottom (latest). On each line, write what happened and why it mattered — the faint notes are starters. Watch how a small break-in became a constitutional crisis.

▲ EARLIEST

FROM A BURGLARY TO A RESIGNATION



★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee Senator **Howard Baker** served as **vice chairman of the Senate Watergate Committee**. His question in the televised hearings — “What did the President know, and when did he know it?” — made him a national figure.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the five stages on cards; sequence them by date before writing why each mattered.

EXTEND

United States v. Nixon said no one is above the law. Explain why that ruling still matters today.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** the sequence aloud, or **diagram** how the cover-up unraveled.

The Birth of the Environmental Movement

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2–3 • Causation

WHEN • WHY Reading it as **warning signs** → **movement** → **new laws** shows how public alarm turned into a permanent federal role in protecting the environment. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

The factors that sparked awareness sit on the left; the movement's effects flow out on the right. Arrows show the chain: warning signs → a movement → new protections.

CAUSES • WHAT SPARKED IT

Rachel Carson's *Silent Spring* 1962 exposes pesticide dangers

Visible pollution — smog, contaminated rivers, oil spills

Earth Day 1970 & a growing science of ecology raise public alarm

THE MOVEMENT

THE ENVIRONMENTAL MOVEMENT

Americans demand that the government protect air, water & land — describe how public concern became national policy

EFFECTS • NEW PROTECTIONS

The EPA is created 1970 — sets & enforces pollution standards

New federal laws regulate air, water & toxic substances

Love Canal — a toxic-waste neighborhood — leads to the Superfund cleanup program

Three Mile Island (1979) raises fears about nuclear safety

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee sat at the center of the debate: the **Tellico Dam** controversy pitted the TVA against efforts to protect the endangered **snail darter**, producing the landmark Supreme Court case ***TVA v. Hill*** (1978) — a defining moment for the Endangered Species Act.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the center box first. Then connect one cause at a time: "Because people saw ____, they demanded ____."

EXTEND

Was the EPA an overreach or a necessary protection? Use the causes and effects to argue.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **design** an Earth Day 1970 poster.

President Carter's Toughest Tests

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY Laying each challenge out as **problem** → **response** → **result** lets students judge Carter fairly — crediting Camp David while weighing the crises that sank his presidency. *Weighing responses against outcomes builds SSP.04 (evaluate).*

Carter met three big challenges. In each column, read the faint hints and write the problem, his response, and the result. Follow the arrows down: **problem** → **response** → **result**.

Stagflation	The Energy Crisis	Diplomacy & Crisis
PROBLEM high inflation (13.5%) <i>and</i> unemployment at once; interest rates near 20%	PROBLEM oil shortages, long gas lines & soaring heating costs	PROBLEM Cold-War tensions, the Panama Canal question & a hostile Iran
CARTER'S RESPONSE voluntary wage-price guidelines; the Federal Reserve tightens money	CARTER'S RESPONSE created the Department of Energy ; urged conservation & less foreign oil	CARTER'S RESPONSE the Camp David Accords (Egypt–Israel peace); Panama Canal treaties
RESULT the measures fell short — the economy stayed weak	RESULT gas lines frustrated the public and damaged him politically	RESULT Camp David was a triumph — but the Iran hostage crisis (444 days) doomed his term

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee Senator **Howard Baker** was a key Republican voice as Senate Minority Leader during these years. And Tennessee banker **Jake Butcher** helped bring the **1982 World's Fair to Knoxville** — one of the last major World's Fairs held in the United States.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the “problem” row across all three columns first, then work down one column at a time.

EXTEND

Which problem was most out of Carter's control? Use the results row to defend your answer.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** the cells, **say** a column aloud, or **rank** the three challenges by difficulty.

The Reagan Era: Pride, Economics & Power

⌚ 15-20 min

Concept Web

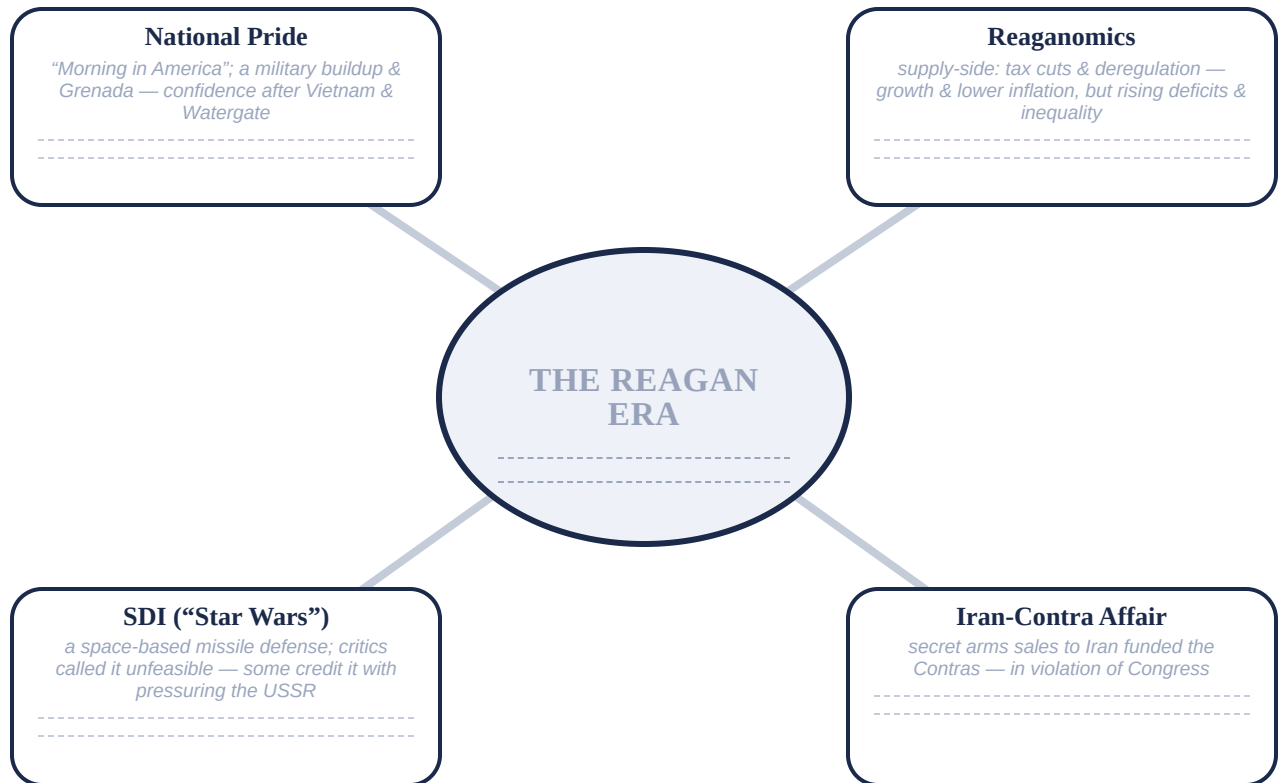
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2-3 • Analyze

WHEN • WHY A web holds Reagan's presidency together — national confidence, supply-side economics, missile defense, and a scandal — so students can weigh its promise and its costs. *Connecting parts to one hub builds SSP.03 (synthesize).*

The hub is the Reagan era. On each bubble, write what that policy or moment did — the faint notes are starters. Then answer the box below: how did Reagan change America's mood and economy?



How did Reagan change America's mood and its economy?

optimism & renewed pride · a booming but more unequal economy · a bigger military and bigger deficits

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee Senator **Howard Baker** served as Reagan's **White House Chief of Staff** (1987–88), and **Lamar Alexander** — later Tennessee governor — was Reagan's **Secretary of Education**, leading education reform.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the four bubble labels; fill "National Pride" together. Ask: who gained, and who lost, under Reaganomics?

EXTEND

Reaganomics grew the economy but widened inequality. Use that bubble to argue whether it was worth it.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **draw** an icon for each part of the era.

The Cold War Ends: Bush and a New World

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline • Change Over Time

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2 • Chronology

WHEN • WHY A timeline lines up the events that ended the Cold War — from the wall's fall to the Soviet collapse — so students see how quickly the world reordered. *Chronological reasoning is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Follow these four turning points from top (earliest) to bottom (latest). On each line, write what happened and why it mattered — the faint notes are starters. Together they mark the end of the Cold War.

▲ EARLIEST

THE COLD WAR ENDS • A NEW WORLD ORDER

Nov 1989

1

The Berlin Wall falls — *communism collapses across Eastern Europe; Bush avoids triumphalism & backs German reunification.*

Dec 1989

2

Panama invasion (*Operation Just Cause*) *removes dictator Manuel Noriega, indicted for drug trafficking.*

1990–91

3

The Gulf War — *Iraq invades Kuwait; Bush builds a UN-backed coalition; Desert Storm liberates Kuwait quickly.*

1991

4

The Soviet Union dissolves — *the Cold War ends and the U.S. stands as the world's sole superpower.*

LATEST • AMERICA AS SOLE SUPERPOWER

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee Senator **Al Gore** ran as the 1988 Democratic vice-presidential nominee before joining Clinton's ticket in 1992. And Tennessee's **Fort Campbell** deployed troops to the Gulf War as part of Operation Desert Storm.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the four events on cards; sequence them by date before writing why each mattered.

EXTEND

Being the “sole superpower” brought new responsibilities. Name one and explain it.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** the sequence aloud, or **map** where each event happened.

WHEN · WHY A matrix holds four very different events against the same two questions, so students see the era's booming economy and its political turmoil at once. *Comparing on structured criteria is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03.*

Compare the four events across the same two questions. The faint notes are starters — write over them, then notice how prosperity and scandal ran side by side.

EVENT → COMPARE ↓	NAFTA 1994 · free trade	Welfare Reform 1996 · work rules	Balanced Budget first since 1969	Impeachment 1998–99
What it was	ended trade barriers among the U.S., Canada & Mexico	work requirements & time limits replaced older welfare (TANF)	growth & tax increases erased the federal deficit	the Lewinsky affair → charges of perjury & obstruction
Outcome	trade rose — but many manufacturing jobs moved to Mexico	welfare rolls fell sharply; poverty reduction was limited	budget surpluses — a strong late-1990s economy	the House impeached; the Senate acquitted — a party-line split

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Vice President **Al Gore of Carthage, Tennessee**, shaped the administration's technology policy and the "information superhighway." He later won the **Nobel Peace Prize** for his environmental advocacy.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill the "What it was" row together first, then let students complete each outcome by column.

EXTEND
Clinton left office popular despite impeachment. Use the outcomes row to explain how that could be.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, or **rank** the four events by lasting impact.

September 11th and America's Response

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

★ Tennessee Connection

DOK 2-3 • Causation

WHEN • WHY Reading it as **attack** → **response** → **consequences** shows how one day reshaped security at home and led to two long wars abroad. *Analyzing cause & effect is TN Social Studies Practice SSP.05.*

Who attacked and why sits on the left; America's responses flow out on the right. Arrows show the chain: the attack → the response → two long wars.

CAUSES • THE ATTACK

al-Qaeda, led by Osama bin Laden, plans the attacks

19 hijackers strike the World Trade Center & the Pentagon — nearly 3,000 killed

the Taliban government in Afghanistan shelters al-Qaeda

THE EVENT

SEPTEMBER 11, 2001

The deadliest attack on U.S. soil reshapes American security & foreign policy — describe how the nation responded

EFFECTS • THE RESPONSE

Homeland Security & the PATRIOT Act — new surveillance & airport security

a "War on Terror" is declared

the Afghanistan War removes the Taliban — and becomes the longest war in U.S. history

the Iraq War — launched on WMD claims that proved false — brings instability

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee's **Fort Campbell 101st Airborne Division** was among the first conventional forces sent to Afghanistan in Operation Enduring Freedom, and the state tightened security at key sites including the **Oak Ridge** nuclear complex.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the center box first. Then connect each response to the attack: "After 9/11, the U.S. ____."

EXTEND

The Iraq War's WMD claims proved false. Explain why that mattered for public trust.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **diagram** the domestic vs. international responses.

Breaking Barriers in American Leadership

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A matrix holds three trailblazers against the same two questions, so students see both the barrier each broke and the impact each had. *Comparing on structured criteria is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03.*

Compare the three leaders across the same two questions. The faint notes are starters — write over them, then notice the “firsts” each achieved and the doors they opened.

LEADER → COMPARE ↓	Sandra Day O'Connor Supreme Court	Colin Powell military & diplomacy	Hillary Clinton politics
Barrier broken	<i>first woman on the U.S. Supreme Court (1981, appointed by Reagan)</i> 	<i>first Black Chairman of the Joint Chiefs; first Black Secretary of State</i> 	<i>First Lady → U.S. Senator → Secretary of State → first woman nominated for president by a major party</i>
Role & impact	<i>a moderate voice who often cast the deciding swing vote</i> 	<i>led Gulf War planning; kept broad respect across party lines</i> 	<i>advocated for healthcare, women's & children's issues at the highest levels</i>

★ **Tennessee Connection** — Tennessee's leadership grew more diverse too: **Harold Ford Jr.** represented Memphis as one of the nation's youngest African American congressmen, and **Marsha Blackburn** became Tennessee's **first female U.S. Senator** in 2019.

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SCAFFOLD

Fill the “**barrier broken**” row together first, then let students complete each leader's impact.

EXTEND

Which “first” do you think opened the most doors for others? Defend your answer.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** in cells, **say** a column aloud, or **match** each leader to the barrier they broke.

From Landlines to Live Streams

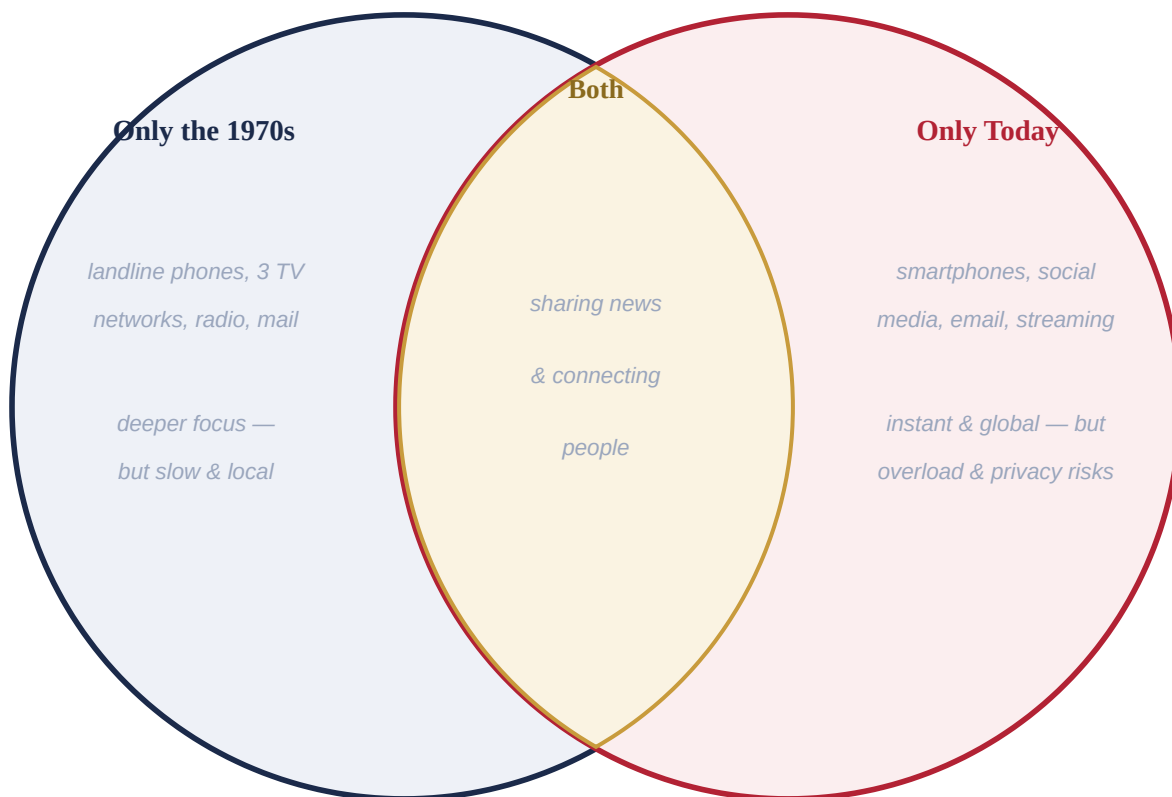
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A Venn makes the **overlap** visible — both eras connect people and share news — while sorting what changed and weighing each era's strengths and limits. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy; SSP.03.*

Compare how Americans communicated in the 1970s with how we communicate today. Write what was unique to each on its side, and what they share in the middle — the faint notes are starters. Note each era's strengths *and* limits.

THE 1970s — slower • local • deliberate

TODAY — instant • global • digital



★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee helped lead the next leap: in 2010 the **Chattanooga** Electric Power Board launched the first citywide **1-gigabit-per-second internet** in the U.S. — making “Gig City” a national model, while Nashville grew into a major tech hub.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill the **Both** region first (what has *not* changed), then sort each method to its era.

EXTEND

Which era's communication was “better”? Use the strengths and limits to defend a position.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), or **interview** an older relative about 1970s communication.

The Obama Years: Achievements & Setbacks

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY A two-column chart weighs accomplishments against setbacks, so students judge the presidency on the full record — not one headline. *Weighing evidence on both sides builds SSP.04 (evaluate).*

On each card, write the details of that achievement or setback — the faint notes are starters. Then answer the band below: what did the Obama years reveal about the power and the limits of the presidency?

ACHIEVEMENTS

what the administration accomplished

Affordable Care Act

"Obamacare" extended health insurance to millions of uninsured Americans

Economic Recovery

the Recovery Act helped end the Great Recession; unemployment fell 10% → 4.7%

Foreign Policy Wins

the Paris Climate accord, the Iran nuclear deal, a Cuba opening, bin Laden killed

Social Progress

advanced marriage equality; created DACA for young immigrants

SETBACKS

what limited or challenged it

Congressional Gridlock

after 2010, GOP opposition brought shutdowns, debt-ceiling fights & a blocked Court seat

Foreign Challenges

Syria's civil war, the rise of ISIS, Russian moves in Ukraine, Benghazi

Deepening Division

persistent racial tensions and a sharply polarized political climate

What did these years show about the power and the limits of the presidency?

A president can drive big change (healthcare, recovery) — but a divided Congress and a polarized nation can stall even a determined agenda

★ **Tennessee Connection.** Tennessee sat at the center of these debates: Senators **Lamar Alexander** and **Bob Corker** played significant roles in Senate battles over healthcare, trade, and foreign policy during the Obama years.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill one achievement and one setback together first, using the faint notes.

EXTEND

Choose the achievement and the setback you think mattered most, and defend both picks.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write** the cards, **say** a side aloud, or **debate** the record in pairs.